

Harappan Civilization: Introduction

- **Named after:** Harappa
- **Also known as:** Indus Valley Civilization
- **Period:** 2600 BCE to 1900 BCE
- **Nature:** Urban civilization

Harappan Civilization: Geography

- **Core areas:** Afghanistan, Jammu, Baluchistan, Pakistan, Gujarat, Rajasthan, UP, Haryana
- **Famous Centers:**
 - **Pakistan:** Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Chanhudaro
 - **India:** Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Lothal, Kalibangan, Banawali, Nageshwar
 - **Afghanistan:** Shortughai

Harappan Civilization: Major Sources

- Remains of structures
- Bricks
- Beads, Jewellery
- Pottery
- Terracotta toys
- Remains of bones and charred grains
- Seals and weights

Subsistence Strategies

Agriculture

- **Crops grown:** Wheat, Barley, Lentil, Sesame, Chickpea, Millets and Rice
- **Major Evidences:**
 - Remains of charred grains, ploughed field
 - Millet found in Gujarat
 - Rice was rare

Pastoralism

- **Animals domesticated:** Goat, sheep, buffalo, pig
- **Animals used for consumption:** Boar, deer, ghariyal, fish, fowl

Technology

- **Plough Agriculture:**
 - Ox was used
 - Wooden Plough was used
- **Major Evidences:**
 - Terracotta Bull
 - Terracotta model of Plough (Banawali)
 - Ploughed field in Kalibangan
- **Irrigation Technology:**
 - Reservoirs and canals were used
- **Major Evidences:**
 - Ruins of reservoir in Dholavira
 - Traces of Canals in Shortughai

Mohenjodaro: Architecture

Lower Town

- Walled and protected
- Larger area than citadel
- Buildings on mud brick platform
- Used for general purposes: residence, trade, craft production

Citadel

- Walled and protected
- Located on high platform but had small area
- Whole structure built on mud brick platform
- **Famous structures:** warehouse, great bath, pillared hall
- Probably used for specific ceremony and rituals

Drainage System

- Drains and roads laid down first, then houses built
- Drains connected with every house
- Grid pattern for roads and drains
- Loose coverings of mud brick for cleaning

Domestic Architecture

- Courtyard for common activities: cooking, weaving
- Some houses had staircases
- Many houses had wells
- Every house had a bathroom
- Courtyard not directly connected with entrance
- No windows on ground floor

Social Differences

Analysis of Burials

- Normal graves, unlike Egyptian pyramids
- Jewellery found in graves of both men and women
- No variation in graves

Analysis of Objects

- **Utilitarian:**
 - Daily use objects (pottery, needles, body scrubbers)
 - Found throughout the Harappan settlements
- **Luxury:**
 - Very rare or made via complicated process (gold, pots of faience)
 - Found only in big settlements like Harappa, Mohenjodaro

Raw Materials for Craft Production

Stones

- **Steatite:**
 - Sources: Southern Rajasthan and Northern Gujarat
- **Lapis Lazuli:**
 - Sources: Shortughai

- **Carnelian:**
 - Sources: Lothal
- **Quartz**
- **Jasper**

Metals

- **Bronze**
- **Copper:**
 - Sources: Khetri region (Rajasthan) and Oman
- **Gold:**
 - Sources: South India

Other Materials

- **Shell:**
 - Sources: Nageshwar and Balakot
- **Faience:**
 - Sources: Procured Locally
- **Burnt Clay:**
 - Sources: Procured Locally

Centres of Craft Production

Major Centres

- **Chanhudaro:** Bead Making, Shell Cutting, Metal Working, Seal Making, Weight Making
- **Lothal and Dholavira:** Drilling
- **Nageshwar and Balakot:** Making Shell Objects

Methods of Centre Identification

- Evidence of Raw materials
- Evidence of Tools
- Evidence of Unfinished Objects
- Evidence of waste

Trade in Harappan Civilization

Evidences

- Mesopotamian texts, seals
- Harappan Jar in Oman
- Harappan seals, beads, weights, dice, and beads
- Depiction of boats and ships on seals

Trade Contacts

- Oman (Magan)
- Bahrain (Dilmun)
- Mesopotamia

Seals, Scripts and Weights

Seals

- Used in long distance communication
- **Two purposes:**
 - Convey identity of sender
 - Ensure safety of goods

Scripts

- Has signs
- Total number of signs: 375-400
- Still undeciphered
- Written from right to left
- Used on seals, copper tools, rims and jars, tablets

Weights

- Made of stone called "Chert"
- Cubical in shape with no markings
- Lower weights followed binary denominations
- Higher weights followed decimal denominations

Authority in Harappan Civilization

Views of Historians

- **1st Opinion:** No rulers, equal status to all
- **2nd Opinion:** Several rulers, every city had different rulers
- **3rd Opinion:** There was a single authority for the whole civilization

End of Harappan Civilization

Late Harappan Civilization

- **Period:** 1900 BCE to 1300 BCE
- Mature Harappan sites abandoned
- Pottery, weights, seals, beads started disappearing
- Expansion of Population in Haryana, Gujarat, West UP

Reason behind Decline

- Climate Change
- Deforestation
- Floods
- Drying up of river
- Overuse of Landscape

Discovering the Civilization

Key Contribution

- **Alexander Cunningham:**
 - First director general of ASI in 1856
 - Harappan seals reached Cunningham in 1870s
 - Compared Harappan seals with texts of Buddhist pilgrims
- **Dayaram Sahni:**
 - Excavated Harappa in 1921
- **R D Banerjee:**
 - Excavated Mohenjodaro in 1922
- **John Marshall:**
 - DG of ASI in 1920s
 - Officially announced the discovery of Harappan civilization in 1924
- **R E M Wheeler:**

- DG of ASI in 1944
- Known for implementation of stratigraphy

Problems in Interpretation

Process of Interpretation

- Recovering Artefacts
- Classifying them
- Analysing Function
- Make Conclusion

Problem in Archaeological Interpretation

- Confusion in reconstructing religious practices
- Script is still undeciphered

The Timeline

- **2600-1900 BCE:** Harappan Civilization
- **1500-600 BCE:** Vedic Civilization
- **600 BCE-600 CE:** Early Historic Period

The Turning Point (6th century BCE)

- Emergence of Early States
- Growing use of Iron
- Development of Heterodox sects (Buddhism, Jainism, Ajivika)
- Development of Coins

The Era of Mahajanapadas

Introduction

- Small kingdoms of Gangetic plains (600 BCE to 4th Century BCE)
- Total 16 Mahajanapadas
- **Famous Mahajanapadas:** Magadha, Vajji, Kosala, Gandhara, Avanti, Kasi, Kuru, Panchala

How did they emerge?

- Massive Use of Iron Tools
- Expansion in Agriculture
- Intensive Animal Rearing

Features

- Each Mahajanapada had a Capital City
- Most were fortified and had permanent Military and bureaucracy
- Tax levied on agricultural surplus
- Tributes extracted from traders, craftsman and hunter
- Raids on neighbouring states were considered legitimate source of revenue

Governance

- **Monarchy:**
 - Ruled by Kings
 - Position of King was hereditary
 - Ex: Magadha, Kosala, Kasi, Panchala
- **Oligarchy:**
 - Ruled by Ganapati
 - Position of Ganapati was not hereditary
 - Ex: Vajji, Malla

Magadha

Location

- Modern Day Bihar

Why it was so Powerful?

- **Reasons:**
 - Productive Agriculture
 - Availability of Iron
 - Availability of Elephants
 - Convenient Communication
 - Ambitious Rulers (Bimbisara, Ajatshatru, Mahapadma Nanda)

Capital

- Initially: Rajagaha (Modern Day Rajgir)
- Later shifted to Pataliputra (Modern Day Patna) in 4th century BCE

Mauryan Empire

Introduction

- Founded by Chandragupta Maurya in 321 BCE
- Pataliputra was the Capital
- Extended till Afghanistan in North to Andhra Pradesh in South

Importance of Empire

- Discovered in 19th century
- Gave a sense of proud to the Nationalists
- Nationalist saw Ashoka as an Indigenous inspiring figure

Major Sources

- **Literary:** Arthashastra, Indica, Buddhist, Jain and Puranic Texts
- **Archaeological:** Edicts of Ashoka, Punch Marked coins, Cave edicts

Ashoka's Reign (272-231 BCE)

- Known for his expansion, spread of Buddhism and governance
- Promoted the philosophy of Dhamma (righteous way of living)
- First King to install inscriptions
- Appointed Dhamma-Mahammata for the spread of Dhamma

Administration

- One capital and four provincial Centres (Taxila, Ujjayini, Tosali and Suvarnagiri)
- Control strongest around capital and provincial centres
- Various committees and sub-committees for Army

Post Mauryan Era

Empires in North

- Shunga
- Kanva
- Guptas

Empires in South

- Satavahanas
- Vakatakas
- Cholas
- Pandyas

Empires in North-west

- Shaka
- Kushana

Major Sources

- Literature: Abhigyan Shakuntalam, Mudrarakshasa
- Coins
- Inscriptions
- Prashastis

New Notions of Kingship

Chiefdoms

- Emerged in South India in 2nd century BCE (Cholas, Cheras, Pandayas)
- Ruled by chiefs

Divine Kings

- Some rulers had obscure origin (Satavahanas, Kushanas)
- Adopted divine titles to gain acceptance
- Ex: Kushanas took titles like Devaputra (Son of God)

Prashastis

- Literature composed in praise
- Written by court poets to impress Kings
- Factual information not totally correct; exaggerated
- Ex: Prayag Prashasti for Samudragupta

The Countryside (600 BCE-600 CE)

Major Sources

- Inscriptions
- Jatakas and Panchatantra
- Give information about peasantry and landowners
- Pastoralists, Hunters, fishermen were beyond the reach

Agriculture

- Production increased due to various strategies:
 - Iron Tipped Plough
 - Transplantation
 - Use of Irrigation through wells, tanks and canals

Features of Land Grants

- Differed in size and rights
- Local people had to obey the recipient (Lord)
- Agrahara: special land grant to Brahmana scholars
- Recorded on stone and copper plates

Land Grants: Whom Given

- Brahmins
- Religious Institutions

Land Grants: Why Given

- To extend Agriculture
- To win allies
- To show fake power

Social Differences

- North India (usually three classes):
 - Large Landholders
 - Small Peasants
 - Landless Labourers
- South India:
 - Vellalar (Large Landowners)
 - Uzhavar (Ploughmen)
 - Adimai (Slaves)

Second Urbanization

Towns in Early Historic Period

- Developed in Gangetic plains
- Famous towns: Pataliputra, Ujjayini, Puhar, Mathura

Sources

- Votive Inscriptions
- Artefacts

Elites and Common People

- Elites:
 - Lived in fortified settlements
 - Used special Northern Black Polished Ware, Ornaments, vessels, Figurines, Weapons
- Common People:
 - Known from Votive inscriptions
 - Organized themselves into Guilds and Shrenis

Trade, Exchange and Coinage

Routes

- Land Routes:
 - Extended to Central Asia via Afghanistan
 - Bullock Carts used
- Marine Routes:
 - Connected to North Africa via Red Sea
 - Connected to Southeast Asia via Bay of Bengal

- Trade carried through Ships
- Note: Successful merchants called Masattuvan (Tamil) and Sethi and Sattavaha (Prakrit)

Materials Traded

- For Export: Salt, Grain, Cloth, Metal Ores, Timber, Spices, Black Pepper
- For Import: Coin, Topaz, Crude Glass, Coral, Tin, Lead

Coinage

- Punch Marked Coins:
 - Made of Copper and Silver
 - Issued by Mahajanpads and Mauryans
- Indo-Greek Coins:
 - First coin to bear the name and Image of Rulers
 - Made of Silver and copper
- Kushana Coins:
 - Issued First Gold Coins
 - Identical in weights with Roman and Parthians (Iran)
 - Largest collection of gold coins
- Gupta Coins:
 - Issued Gold Coins
 - Most Spectacular Gold Coins
 - Known for their purity
- Yaudheya Coins:
 - Tribal republic of Punjab Haryana
 - Issued numerous Copper Coins

Inscriptions

General Features

- Engraved on Hard Surface (Stone, Metal and Pottery)
- Permanent Records
- Some carry dates, others dated based on Palaeography
- Earliest Inscriptions issued in Prakrit
- Primarily records:
 - Achievements and Orders of Kings
 - Donations made by people

Deciphering the Inscriptions

Brahmi Script

- European Scholars with Indian Pundits compared Brahmi with contemporary Devanagari and Bengali script
- Script discovered based on these comparisons

Kharosthi Script

- Deciphered by comparing letters with Greek letters

Limitations

- Technical Limitations:
 - Faintly engraved letters
 - Missing and damaged Letters
 - Confusion about exact meaning of inscriptions
- Fundamental Limitations:
 - Not every important information recorded
 - Biased as per the perspective of issuer
 - Lack of information about common people

Critical Edition of Mahabharata

What was in it?

- Project on Mahabharata led by V.S Sukthankar
- Sanskrit Manuscripts from all over India collected and compared

Insights of Research

- Researched for 47 years
- Team selected common elements and compiled them in a text of more than 13,000 pages
- Added regional variations in footnote

Conclusion

- Various common elements were there
- Few regional variations present
- Rules written in Sanskrit versions were not followed universally

Kinship, Caste and Class

What is Kinship?

- Web of social relationships
- Forms an important part of Human existence

How a Kinship is formed?

- Basis: Blood, Marriage, Adoption

Concept of Family

- Part of Kinfolk
- Familial ties often blooded and married
- Each family is unique

Elements of Kinship

- Kula (Family)
- Jnati (Kinfolk)
- Vamsa (Lineage)

The Idea of Patriliney

Definition

- Descent traced from male progenitor/parent
- Sons could claim share in father's property when he died

Patriliney in ancient India

- Most common social feature of ancient India
- All ruling dynasties of Mahajanpada followed this system
- Prevalent after Mahabharata composed (500 BCE to 400 CE)
- Followed by ordinary people too

Exceptions of Patriliney

- Brother succeeded the throne
- Kinsman succeeded the throne
- Woman succeeded the throne (rarest of the rarest), e.g., Prabhavati Gupta

Rules of Marriage

Common Notions

- Marrying outside the Kin was desirable
- Father's responsibility to marry his daughter at right age with right man
- Led to the concept of Kanyadana

Types of marriages

- Endogamy: Marrying within a unit
- Exogamy: Marrying outside the unit
- Polygyny: Marrying with more than one girl
- Polyandry: Marrying with more than one husband

Where, whom and why the rules were written

- Rules written in Dharmashastra
- Written for elite as was ordinary people
- Written because the Brahmins wanted to bound people into a code of conduct

Ashtavivah

- In Manusmriti, eight types of marriages prescribed
- First four considered legitimate, rest four prohibited

Gotra of Women

Origin

- Emerged around 1000 BCE
- Name of Gotra derived after Vedic seers
- All people of same gotra considered to have been of same descent

Rules of Gotra

- People of same gotra couldn't marry
- Women had to leave gotra of father after marriage
- Had to accept the gotra of their husband

Exception

- Communities in south India didn't abide the rules of gotra
- Satvahana rulers also married in the same gotra

Metronymics

- Deriving name from the gotra of mother
- Ex: Gotami Putta Satakarni, Vasithi Putta Pulamayi

Varna System

Intro

- Hierarchical order mentioned in Dharmashastra
- Position determined by birth

Four Varna

- Brahmana
- Kshatriya
- Vaishya
- Shudra

Ideal Occupations

- Brahmana: Study Vedas, Teach Vedas, Perform Sacrifices, Get Sacrifices Performed, Give and Receive Gifts
- Kshatriya: Engage in Warfare, Protect and administer people, Study Vedas, Get sacrifices performed, Send Gifts
- Vaishya: Agriculture, Pastoralism, Trade, Study Vedas, Get Sacrifices Performed, Send Gifts
- Shudra: To serve Other Varnas

Methods of Implementation

- Refer Divine Origin
- Advise king to implement
- Persuade people to accept
- Refer story of Mahabharata

Violation of Dharmashastra

Non-Kshatriya Rulers

- Satavahana, Shunga, Kanva
- Shaka, Kushana

Marriage in same Gotra

- Satvahana rulers married girls of same gotra
- South Indian communities also married in their kinfolk

Inter-community marriage

- Satvahana and Shaka marriage alliance
- Bhima and Hidimba marriage

The Untouchables

Origin

- As per Dharmashastra, all activities divided into Pure and polluted activities
- Chandals (Untouchables) were those who used to do polluted activities (handling corpses, disposing waste)

Duties as per Manusmriti

- Live outside the Village
- Use discarded utensils
- Could not walk in villages and cities
- Dispose bodies of strangers

Did they accept this misery?

- Not always.



Distribution of wealth b/w men and women

Methods of acquiring wealth

- **For men:** Inheritance, finding, Purchase, Conquest, Investment, Work, gifts
- **For Women:** Gifts during marriage, gifts from brother, mother, father
- Women allowed to retain the gifts without the permission of husband
- Women could not hold any inherited property without the permission of husband

Property Rights

- Property to be equally divided between sons with eldest given special share
- Daughter's could not claim anything

Exception

- Prabhavati Gupta reigned Vakataka Kingdom for years and yielded power

Distribution of Wealth b/w varnas

- **Brahmana:**
 - Usually wealthy
 - Sources: Gifts, land grants
- **Kshatriya:**
 - Wealthy
 - Sources: Conquest, taxes, tributes
- **Vaishya:**
 - Neither too rich nor too poor
 - Source: Agriculture, Pastoralism
- **Shudra:**
 - Extremely poor

Social Differences in Buddhism

- Consider Social Differences as artificial and flexible
- As per Sutta Pitaka, initially human beings were not fully evolved and lived with peace
- With time, they became greedy and needed a leader to ensure their well being
- They elected "Mahasamatta" and hence social difference was seeded

How a text is analysed?

1. Analysis of Language

- **Language can be of two types:**
 - **Elite's language:** Sanskrit
 - **Language of Commons:** Pali, Prakrit, Tamil

2. Type of content

- Historians analyse whether the text is a story or compilation of mantras

3. Author and Target audience

- Who wrote and for whom

4. Date and Time of Composition

- When and where the texts are written

The text of Mahabharata

Author

- Originally story composed by charioteer bards who accompanied warriors
- As per Sanatan tales, Sage Vyas composed the text

Language and content

- Written in Sanskrit Language
- Sanskrit used in Mahabharat is easier than the same used in Vedas
- Divided into two type of content: Didactic and Narrative

A Dynamic Text

- Written in variety of languages
- Over time influenced by many regional stories

Written Compilation

- 500 BCE to 400 CE
- Some didactic verses added between 200 BCE to 200 CE
- More than 100,000 verses

Archaeological Efforts

Introduction

- In 1951-52, archaeologist B.B.Lal excavated Hastinapura near Merrut in Uttar Pradesh.

Key Findings

- Walls of mud and mud-bricks found, dated back to 12th to 7th century BCE
- Walls of mud-bricks and burnt-brick found with various terracotta structures, dated back to 6th century BCE

Thinkers, Beliefs and Buildings

Introduction

- Great Stupa of Sanchi originally Built by Ashoka: the Great in 3rd century BCE
- Oldest stone structure in India
- Surrounded by many stupa and temples built later on.

Discovery of Stupa

- Discovered by General Henry Taylor in 1818
- Alexander Cunningham excavated the site in 1851
- With help of Shahjehan Begum and Sultan Janan Begum the structure restored and preserved.

Role of rulers of Bhopal in preservation

- Refused to give the original artefacts to British and French.
- Her successor Sultan Jehan Begum funded the research of John Marshall on Sanchi
- Helped in publishing the research volume of John Marshall and funded the construction of Museum there.

The Sacrificial tradition

Origin

- During Rig Vedic age from Rig Veda
- Main deities: Agni, Indra, Varuna, Soma
- Initially, done collectively and not much popular

Change in Later Vedic age

- Sacrificial tradition became more popular and individualistic
- Elaborate Sacrifices performed (Rajasuya, Ashwamedha)
- Led to prime dominance of Priestly class in India

Objectives of Sacrifices

- Get food
- Get wealth
- Get Nourishment
- Get cow and sons

Debates and Discussions

Why Debates?

- With increasing popularity of Upanishads, horizon of thinking got wider
- People started questioning the orthodox tradition

The most debated topic

- Authority of Veda
- Emphasis on Individual existence
- Life after death
- The Certainty of God

Where the debates were organized?

- Debates took place in Kutagarashala (a hut with a pointed roof)
- As per Buddhist texts, there were 64 schools of thought who used to engage in debates

Heterodox Sects

Meaning

- Group of people who discards the orthodox beliefs and questions the existing ideas
- **Famous Heterodox sects:** Jainism, Ajivika, Lokayata, Buddhism

Reason behind emergence

- Increase in Popularity of Sacrificial Tradition
- Exposure with global ideologies
- Rigidity of Vedic Religion
- Increasing dominance of Brahmanical ideas

Lokayata

- Founded by Charvaka
- **Basic Principle:**
 - Rejected the idea of Karma, afterlife, rebirth, incarnations
 - Promoted the sensual pleasure
 - Promoted the concept of skepticism

Ajivika

- Founded by Makkhali Gosala
- Everything is pre-determined
- Belief that there is no creator or God
- **Six Inevitable truth:**
 - Gain & Loss
 - Joy & Sorrow
 - Life & Death

Jainism

Introduction

- Tradition started with 1st Tirthankara Rishabhanatha
- Religion earlier known as Nirgrantha
- After Mahavira (24th Tirthankara), religion became known as Jain

Basic Principle

- Extreme non-violence
- Escape misery through penance
- Everything has life
- Cycle of Birth is shaped through Karma
- Egalitarianism

Life of Mahavira

- Born in 599 BCE in Kundalgram, Vaishali Bihar
- Parents: Siddhartha, Trishala
- Abandoned Royal Life at age of 30
- Attained Omniscience (Kevala Jnana) under a Sala tree at age of 43

Five Great Vows

- Not to kill or Injure anyone
- Not to steal
- Not to lie
- Celibacy
- Not to Possess Property

Buddhism

Life of Buddha

- Born in Shakya Clan as Siddhartha in 563 BCE
- Left home at age of 29, known as Mahabhinishkramana
- Got enlightenment at age of 35 under a peepal tree in Bodh Gaya

- Preached first sermon at Sarnath, known as Dhammachakrapavattana
- Parinirvana at age of 80 at Kshuinagar

Teachings of Buddha

- World is transient and constantly changing (anicca)
- It is soulless
- Sorrow (dukkha) is intrinsic to human being
- Path of moderation can help people to get above these worldly troubles
- Individual efforts and righteous actions are needed for the self realisation
- Promoted ahimsa and equality

Triptakas of Buddhism

- Group of three epics where everything about Buddhism compiled by disciples of Buddha
- **Sutta Pitaka:** Teaching of Buddha
- **Vinaya Pitaka:** Rules of Sangha
- **Abhidhamma Pitaka:** Philosophical matters
- Triptakas written in Pali

Reason behind Spread of Buddhism

Rules of Sangha

- Sangha regulated the sect of Buddhism
- Initially only men allowed, but after mediation of Ananda (disciple of Buddha), female also allowed to Join sangha
- Followers treated equally in Sangha irrespective of their backgrounds
- Decisions in Sangha taken through deliberations and collective vote

Reason behind Spread of Buddhism

- Promotion of equality
- Translation of texts in various languages
- Patronage by kings like Ashoka and Kanishka

What are Stupas?

- Mound like structure where the relics (material and Physical) of Buddha is stored.
- Earliest stupas built since 3rd century BCE

Why are Stupas built?

- To store the relics of Buddha
- Emperor Ashoka distributed the relics of Buddha across India in each important towns.

Structure of Stupa

- **Various architectural elements:**
 - Anda
 - Harmika
 - Yashti
 - Chatri
 - Toran Dwar

How they were built?

- For the construction of stupas Donations were given.
- **Donations from:**
 - Kings
 - Guilds
 - Men & Women
 - Bhikkhus & Bhikkhunis

Amravati Stupa

Timeline

- **1796:** Local king ordered the construction of temple with stones of Stupa
- **1798:** Colin Mackenzie visited site
- **1800-24:** Mackenzie made drawing of stupa
- **1854:** Walter Eliot took marble of Stupa to Madras
- **1850s:** Massive loot of Stupa

Reason behind devastation

- No leadership like Shahjehan Begum and Sultan Jehan Begum
- People did not understand the historical importance of stupa.

The Sole Saviour

- H.H. Cole proposed the idea of in-situ preservation
- Said plaster models should be utilized for the installation of artefacts on museum

Role of Sculpture

Stories

- Stories from Jataka tales depicted in the gateways of Sanchi Stupa.

Symbol of Worship

- **Empty seat:** Meditation of Buddha
- **Wheel:** Sermon of Buddha
- **Stupa:** Mahaparinirvana of Buddha

Non-Buddhist Symbols

- **Shalhanjika:** Symbol of auspiciousness
- **Elephant:** Strength and wisdom
- **Gajalakshmi:** Goddess of God Fortune

Rise of New tradition

Hinayana and Mahayana

•Hinayana:

- Follows the teachings of Buddha
- Treats Buddha as Human
- Spread Mostly in Indo-china, Sri Lanka
- Believes in meditation

•Mahayana:

- Worship the idol of Buddha to get Nirvana
- Treats Buddha as God
- Spread Mostly in east Asia (China, Japan, Thailand, Tibet)
- Believes in idol worship and mantra chanting

Growth of Puranic Hinduism

- Form of Hinduism where people get devoted to their chosen deity
- Some popular deities were Shiva, Vishnu, Durga

Shaivism and Vaishnavism**•Shaivism:**

- Ultimate devotion to Shiva
- Concept of Linga got popularized

•Vaishnavism:

- Ultimate devotion to Vishnu
- Worship different incarnations of Vishnu

Construction of Early temples

Why the temples were built?

- With the growth of puranic Hinduism, people needed an established place for the idols of deities
- Led to the construction of temples

The earliest temple

- Temples began to built from 4th century CE
- One of the earliest temple is temple of Deogarh
- Earliest temple only had garbhagriha

Cave temples

- Tradition of artificial cave initiated by Ashoka in 3rd century BCE with construction of Barabar Cave for Ajivika monks
- Later Ajanta and Ellora caves built In Maharashtra by various empire between 2nd century BCE to 1000 CE
- Kailashnath temple located inside the Ellora caves is an example of Cave temple.
- Built from single rock

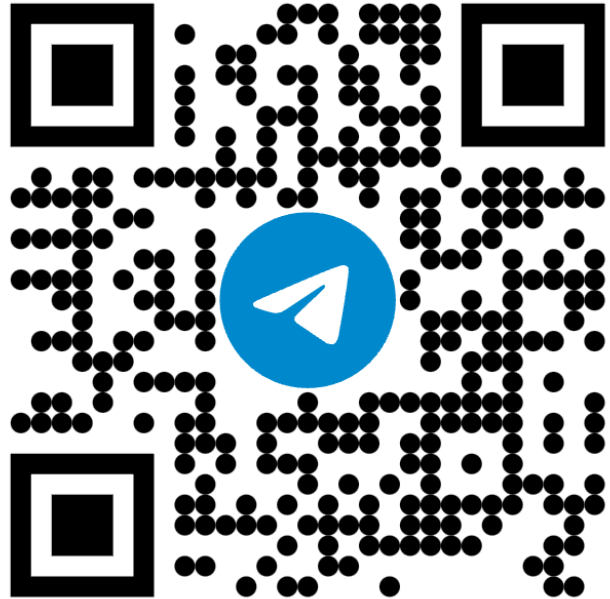
Interpretation of Sculptures

How it is done?

- Done by Art-historians
- Find the evidence of sculptures in texts to understand them
- Even compare them with Greek sculptures

Problems in interpretation

- Sometimes text would not match with image
- Sometimes get different information about image from different texts



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